- **Mughal Period**

10. With reference to the economic history of medieval India. the term'Araghatta' refers to
(a) bonded labour
(b) land grants made to military officers
(c) waterwheel used in the irrigation of land
(d) waterland converted to cultivated land

Ans. (c) : In Sanskrit, the word Araghatta has been used in ancient texts to describe the Persian wheel. The Ara-ghatta comes from the combination of the words 'ara' meaning spoke and 'ghatta' meaning pot. There is evidence to argue that this system of lifting water from open wells was probably invented in India of the past. With its use in Iran, then Persia and perhaps its discovery there is coming to be called the Persian wheel.

Modern History

- **Social, Cultural, Awakening, Lower, Caste Trade Unions and Peasant Movements**

11. With reference to the cultural history of medieval India, Consider the following statements.
1. Siddha (Sittars) of Tamil region were monotheistic and condemned idolatry.
2. Lingayats of Kannada region questioned the theory of rebirth and rejected the caste hierarchy.

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) : Siddhas (Sittars) Saiva school in Tamil Nadu held a monotheistic puritan creed and vehemently condemned idolatry, their history are not known. They seem to be known as most active during 16th and 17th century.
The Lingayats worshiper of Saiva challenged the idea of caste and the "pollution" attributed to certain groups by Brahmanas. They also questioned the theory of rebirth. These won them, followers, amongst those who were marginalized within the Brahmanical social order.

12. Satya Shodhak samaj organized
(a) a movement for upliftment of tribals in Bihar
(b) a temple-entry movement in Gujarat
(c) an anti -caste movement in Maharashtra
(d) a peasant movement in Punjab

Ans. (c) : Satyashodhak Samaj was an association started by Jyotiba Phule in Poona in 1873 for asserting the worth of man irrespective of caste. He demanded representation of all classes of the Hindus in all the local bodies, in services and institutions and also established a primary school for the so-called untouchables in Poona.

13. Consider the following :
1. Calcutta Unitarian Committee (Calcutta Unitarian Committee)
2. Tabernacle of New Dispensation (Tabernacle of New Dispensation)
3. Indian Reform Association (Indian Reform Association)

Keshab Chandra Sen is associated with the estalishment of which of the above ?
(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): Calcutta Unitarian Committee was established in 1823 by Rammohan Roy, Dwarkanath Tagore and William Adam. So, (1) is wrong.
• In 1868, Keshab laid in the foundation stone of his new church, the Tabernacle of New Dispensation. So, (2) is correct.
• Indian reform association was founded in 1870 with Keshab Chandra Sen as president. In represented the secular side of the Brahmo Samaj and included many shows did not belong to the Brahmo Samaj. So, (3) is correct.

- **Freedom Struggle and National Movement**

14. What was the main reason for the split in the Indian National Congress at Surat in 1907 ?
(a) Introduction of communalism into Indian politics by Lord Minto.
(b) Extremists lack of faith in the capacity of the moderates to negotiate with the British Government.
(c) Foundation of Muslim League
(d) Aurobindo Ghosh's inability to be elected as the President of the Indian National Congress .

Ans. (b) : Surat split refers to the splitting of the Congress party into 'Moderates' and 'Extremists' after a clash of the session. The extremists were led by Lokmanya Tilak, Lala Lajpat Rai and Sri Aurobindo and the Moderates were led by Gopal Krishna Gokhale, Pherozeshah Mehta and Surendranath Banerjee. The divided Congress re-united in the crucial Lucknow session of Congress in 1916.

15. The plan of Sir Stafford Cripps envisaged that after the Second World War.
(a) India should be granted complete Independence
(b) India Should be partitioned into two before granting independence
(c) India should be made a republic with condition that she will join the Commonwealth
(d) India should be given Dominion status

Ans. (d) : Cripps Mission was sent to India under the presidentship of Stafford Cripps in March 1942. The intention was the get Indian support for Britishers in the ongoing World War II.
- It proposed to establish an Indian Dominion that will be free to decide its relations with the commonwealth and United Nations constituent assembly to be convened to frame a new constitution. Any province not willing to join the Union could have a separate constitution and form a separate state.

Acceptance of Indian constitution by British government would be subject to condition that any province would have the right to have a separate union and a treaty to be negotiated to affect the power transfer to safeguard racial and religious minorities.
It does not have any condition regarding partition of India for making India republic or joining the commonwealth of Nation.

16. The 'Swadeshi' and 'Boycott' adopted as methods of struggle for the first time during the
(a) agitation against the Partition of Bengal
(b) Home Rule Movement
(c) Non-Cooperation Movement
(d) visit of the Simon Commission to India

Ans. (a) : 'Swadeshi and boycott' were first used as a method of struggle and protest during the movement against the partition of Bengal. It is noteworthy that the Swadeshi movement started on 7 August, 1905 in protest against the declaration of partition of Bengal in July 1905 by Lord Curzon.

17. The Montague-Chelmsford Proposals were related to
(a) Social reforms
(b) educational reforms
(c) reforms in police administration
(d) constitutional reforms

Ans. (d): The Government of India Act, 1919 was passed to expand the participation of Indians in the government of India. The Act embodied the reforms recommended by Edwin Montague and the Viceroy Lord Chelmsford (Montague Chelmsford Reforms). The Act was convened in ten years from 1919 to 1929.

INDIAN GEOGRAPHY

- **Physical Geology, Drainage System, Human Geography**

18. Recently, linking of which of the following rivers was undertaken ?
(a) Cauvery and Tungabhadra
(b) Godavari and Krishna
(c) Mahanadi and Sone
(d) Narmada and Tapti

Ans. (b) : The plan is to eventually divert water from the Polavaram dam since the dam is still under construction and will take at least 4 to 5 years to be ready. The Chandrababu Naidu government decided to divert Godavari water from the Pattiseema Lift Irrigation Scheme. The link plan kicked off on 16 September, 2015.

19. Which of the following is/are tributary/ tributaries of Brahmaputra?
1. Dibang
2. Kameng
3. Lohit

Select the corrrect answer usin the code given below :
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d) : The Brahmaputra enters India in the state of Arunachal Pradesh from its original source Tibet, and is joined by the Dibang river and the Lohit River at the head of the Assam Valley. It is joined in Sonitpur by the Kameng River (or Jia Bhoreli). Brahmaputra's main left bank tributaries are viz Dibang or Sikang and Lohit. The important right bank tributaries are the Subansiri Kameng, Manas and Sankosh. Therefore (d) is correct option.

20. With reference to 'Red Sanders', sometimes seen in the news, consider the following statements :
1. It is a tree species found in a part of South India.
2. It is one of the most important trees in the tropical rain forest areas of South India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a) : Pterocarpus Santaldinus, with the common names red sanders, red sandalwood and saunderswood, is found in southern Eastern Ghats mountain. They are placed under the 'near threatened' category by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN). It occurs in the forest formation, which is classified as "Southern Tropical Dry Deciduous Forests".It is generally formed at an altitude of 150-900 m. It grows on dry, hilly, often rocky ground.
So clearly (b) is incorrect.